Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Centrica Lodge

Centrica Lodge, Gaer Road, Newport, NP20 3GX

01633 839768

www.newport.gov.uk

The inspection visit took place on 28/01/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Newport City Council Adults and Children's Services
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care, Provision for learning disability
Registered places:	6
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:

Well-being	Excellent
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Excellent

Summary:

Centrica Lodge is an adult respite service operated by the local authority. Relatives and professionals consistently told us the service is highly valued and plays an important role within the local and neighbouring communities.

People experience excellent well-being outcomes, supported by strong and effective leadership and management. People enjoy consistently high emotional well-being, highly personalised support, and warm, trusting relationships with care staff. Engagement is meaningful and empowering, and staff maintain familiar routines, so people's stays feel comfortable, reassuring, and enjoyable. Families expressed very high confidence in the service, describing their loved ones as being in *"safe hands."* The team works closely with professionals to support positive risk-taking within a supportive and inclusive culture.

Care and support is good, with areas of excellence, but overall good. People are supported by a

consistent staff team who are guided by personalised care documentation focused on routines, preferences, and what matters to each person. Reviews are frequent and proactive, and work is under way to strengthen their effectiveness to ensure all information is checked carefully before each stay. This will ensure all information about people's needs and risks remains accurate and up to date. The environment is also good. The home is clean, safe, accessible, and increasingly homely following recent improvements. People benefit from a well-maintained house, appropriate equipment, with positive feedback from families and professionals.

Findings:

Well-being — Excellent

People experience high levels of emotional well-being at the service. With few exceptions, people are enthusiastic about attending and consistently return home happy, settled, and relaxed. Many relatives told us their loved ones see their stay as a "*holiday*", describing them as *"excited when they go"*, *"smiling and happy"*, and *"buzzing after the weekend"*. People experience joy, comfort, and a strong sense of emotional security.

People receive highly personalised and flexible support that reflects their routines, sensory needs, communication methods, and preferences. Care staff know people exceptionally well and anticipate what helps them feel secure and comfortable. This highly attuned support enables people to maintain control, feel reassured, and achieve positive day-to-day well-being outcomes.

Activities offered to people are meaningful, creative, and tailored. People engage in a wide range of purposeful experiences, including bowling, meals out, pantomime trips, independent living skills practice, and calm routines after attending day centres. Families told us staff "*take him out at weekends*" and "*do quite a bit… to involve him in independent skills*." These enriching experiences promote independence, enhance confidence, and contribute significantly to people's sense of purpose and fulfilment.

People feel emotionally safe, and families express very high levels of trust in the service. Several relatives told us they "*do not worry*" when their loved one stays because they know they are "*well looked after, safe and happy."* This strong emotional security reflects a highly supportive culture where people feel valued, listened to, and protected, resulting in excellent well-being outcomes.

We observed warm, respectful interactions initiated by care staff. Relationships between people and care staff are a particular strength. Staff interactions are consistently described as warm, respectful, and family-like. The stability and continuity of the staff team help people build strong, trusting relationships, enabling people to feel known, understood, and confident throughout their stay.

Communication at the service is highly effective. Families consistently praised the clarity and reliability of information, saying *"communication is key… they are very good at getting back to you."* People and their representatives receive regular emails before stays, as well as updates and photos if they request this, which helps them feel connected, informed, and reassured.

Care & Support — Good

People receive the quality care and support they need to achieve their personal outcomes. People experience strong and consistent care and support. We observed positive lived experiences, with people's routines respected and their independence supported throughout the day. Care workers know people well and use this knowledge to promote positive outcomes. During our observations, two care workers and three people shared warm, familiar interactions that created a relaxed, family-like atmosphere. Feedback from families reflects this. Representatives told us care workers are *"fabulous"*, and described staff as longstanding, friendly and professional. One representative explained, *"He knows all the staff… it's usually the same team"*, and others highlighted staff *"show passion and genuine care"*. This demonstrates continuity of care and the benefits of stable, familiar staffing.

People's personal plans are person-centred and set out how care workers should support them to achieve their well-being. Plans consistently capture people's preferences and routines. Before each respite stay, representatives are invited to take part in reviews, helping to keep information current. Reviews happen frequently and staff complete them proactively. However, they need to include more meaningful evaluation to show clearly how people's needs, abilities or risks are changing.
Updated care documentation should be shared with people's representatives, and with other professionals where relevant, so everyone can confirm the information remains accurate. This would strengthen the quality of the documentation and ensure care workers follow the most up-to-date guidance. Improvement is also needed in daily recording systems, so they capture what people have experienced, which activities they take part in, and the meaningful engagement achieved during each stay.

People's medication is safely managed. People receive their medicines as prescribed. Care workers follow national guidance and the provider's updated medication policy. Medication processes have been strengthened, with revised systems for recording, storing, and returning medicines. Medication is now stored correctly, and the revised procedures are safe and robust.

People are protected from harm and abuse. People feel safe and care workers respond appropriately when concerns arise. Care workers understand their safeguarding responsibilities and act quickly to address issues. Leaders reflect on mistakes and take swift action to prevent them happening again. Care staff are robustly vetted before working in the service, and they are appropriately monitored, supervised, and well trained to meet the needs of people using the service.

Environment — Good

People live in an environment that supports their well-being outcomes. The home is warm, clean, and welcoming, and improvements over the past year have had a positive impact on people's experiences. The house has been renovated and redecorated, creating brighter and more homely, shared spaces. People and their representatives told us the environment feels "*much more improved",* "*always clean*", and "*more homely*". One person's representative commented *"the house has been redecorated really nicely."* These changes help people feel comfortable and relaxed during their stay.

The provider ensures the premises are safe and well maintained. We saw all required health and safety checks and audits completed consistently, with clear action plans and follow-up reviews recorded in quality assurance reports. Leaders carry out reflective reviews to monitor improvement and act promptly when work is needed. During the inspection, we observed a tidy and hygienic home, with good infection control awareness and practices in place. Staff follow clear procedures to maintain cleanliness, and equipment is serviced and checked appropriately to support people's safety.

The layout of the home supports people's needs, offering spacious communal areas and accessible private bedrooms. Bedrooms still require further individualisation, but the overall standard is good and continuing to improve. The environment includes specialist equipment to meet people's physical needs, such as ceiling-track hoists, height-adjustable beds, an accessible bath, and low-level kitchen surfaces. This ensures people receive safe and dignified support.

Outdoor space is available, so that people can enjoy spending time in the garden. The provider will consider enhancing the garden further to include suitable equipment designed for people with autism or learning disabilities, such as swings, movement-based apparatus and water-play resources. Developing this area further would strengthen sensory engagement and help people with emotional regulation.

We observed safe movement throughout the environment. People can navigate the premises easily, and clear systems are in place to identify and address environmental risks. Leaders monitor any accidents or incidents linked to the environment and arrange for any repair work needed. They also work closely with health and social care partners to review and address any issues.

Leadership & Management — Excellent

The provider demonstrates a very strong commitment to sharing information about events at the service, fostering transparency and high levels of trust and accountability in line with their duty of candour. The service updates families regularly through a newsletter and hosts in person get togethers, invitations into the home, and gradual transition visits that help people and staff get to know each other. We also reviewed the service user guide, including easy-read formats, which clearly set out what people can expect from the service and support openness and transparency. Professionals praised communication, describing it as *"excellent"* and told us the team is *"extremely accommodating and flexible."* They described the service as *"an invaluable resource to adults and their families, offering high quality care, consistency, and peace of mind."*

The service provider has strong working relationships with others in the sector, sharing best practice to promote high quality care for people. There is highly effective collaboration with health and social care professionals to support positive risk taking, ensuring people with higher support needs continue to access the provision and remain included in group activities. Professionals told us, *"with Centrica they want to give everyone a chance,"* and recognised how the service has adapted to meet the increasing complexity of people's needs.

People are confident giving feedback because they know this is welcomed and responded to in a spirit of partnership. Relatives consistently described management as *"very approachable"*, *"committed to making stays enjoyable."*, *"the manager has been really good… we've never had to chase them up"* and *"I certainly do trust this team… those little things do matter."* Care staff described a *"friendly working environment,"* and families and professionals consistently spoke highly of the team's stability, skill and commitment. There is a positive and inclusive culture where leaders value people's experiences, support staff effectively, and respond openly. People have high levels of confidence in the provider because leaders promote a supportive, respectful culture focused on people's well-being.

The service has robust governance arrangements, supported by strong Responsible Individual (RI) oversight and regular quality assurance checks. We read highly effective, clear and detailed RI reports, underpinned by reflective audits and analysis which focuses on people's outcomes, demonstrating a clear commitment to continuous improvement. Leaders monitor all aspects of the service, including accidents, incidents, concerns and complaints, and take prompt action where required.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

Mae’r adroddiad hwn hefyd ar gael yn Gymraeg

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